

Document 20: Convocation & Degree Award Requirements

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. Absolute Prerequisites for Degree Conferral

The award of the Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) degree from the Hyderabad Institute of Technology is not an automatic administrative process upon the completion of four years. A student must satisfy a rigorous set of academic, financial, and disciplinary prerequisites to be deemed eligible for graduation.

First and foremost, the student must have successfully accumulated the statutorily required 160 academic credits within the maximum permissible timeframe (the N+2 rule, equating to a maximum of six years for standard admissions). If a student has accumulated 159 credits, they will not graduate; there are no grace credits awarded under any circumstances.

Secondly, the student must initiate and complete the "Comprehensive No-Dues Routing Protocol." In the first week of May during their eighth semester, eligible students must log into the portal and trigger the digital No-Dues workflow. This automated system seeks financial and disciplinary clearance from exactly seven distinct institutional nodal points: The Departmental Head, the Central Library, the Hostel Administration, the Sports Directorate, the IT Infrastructure Desk, the Training & Placement Cell, and the Central Accounts Office. If even one nodal point flags a pending issue—such as an unreturned basketball, an unpaid late-entry hostel fine, or a missing digital library book—the degree processing is instantly halted, and the student's name is struck from the preliminary graduation roster.

2. Provisional vs. Original Degree Certificates

The university recognizes that students require immediate proof of graduation to join corporate employment or apply for international master's programs long before the formal convocation ceremony takes place. Therefore, HIT issues two distinct graduation documents on two separate timelines.

The **Provisional Certificate (PC)** and the Consolidated Grade Memorandum (CMM) are issued exactly twenty-one calendar days after the publication of the final eighth-semester results, provided the student has successfully cleared the No-Dues protocol. The PC acts as a legally binding, temporary proof of graduation. It is digitally signed, watermarked, and widely accepted by multinational corporations and foreign embassies for visa processing.

The **Original Degree (OD)**, a heavy-parchment document embossed with the university's gold foil seal and physically signed by the Chancellor, is exclusively awarded during the Annual Convocation Ceremony. The convocation is traditionally held in the month of November following the student's graduation in May. The Provisional Certificate remains fully valid until the Original Degree is formally conferred.

3. Convocation Registration and the Academic Regalia Code

Attendance at the Annual Convocation Ceremony is highly encouraged but requires a formalized registration process. Exactly forty-five days before the scheduled convocation date, the university opens the "Convocation Registration Window" on the alumni portal.

Every graduating student, regardless of whether they plan to attend the ceremony in person or collect their degree later, must pay a mandatory Convocation Processing Fee of ₹3,500. This fee covers the printing of the parchment degree, the institutional archival costs, and the lifetime alumni registry maintenance. Students who wish to physically walk across the stage must explicitly check the "Attending In-Person" box during registration.

The Academic Regalia Code: HIT abandons colonial-era black gowns in favor of a modern, culturally rooted academic dress code.

- Male graduands must wear a formal white or cream-colored Kurta Pajama or a tailored dark business suit.
- Female graduands must wear a white or cream-colored handloom Saree, a formal Salwar Kameez, or a dark business suit.
- Over this formal attire, every student must wear the official HIT Academic Sash, which is provided at the registration desk on the morning of the convocation. The sash color is strictly branch-specific: Navy Blue for Computer Science, Maroon for Electronics, Black for Mechanical, and Forest Green for Civil Engineering. Students graduating with the "B.Tech with Honors" distinction will receive a specialized sash featuring gold-threaded borders.
- Any student arriving at the staging area in jeans, t-shirts, casual sandals, or unauthorized sash colors will be permanently denied entry into the auditorium and will not cross the stage.

4. Academic Medals and the Strict Tie-Breaker Protocol

During the convocation, the university honors its most exceptional scholars by awarding the prestigious Chancellor's Gold, Silver, and Bronze Medals for each engineering branch.

To be considered for any academic medal, a student must meet the **First-Attempt Clearance Rule**. The student must have passed every single subject, laboratory, and project from Semester 1 through Semester 8 on their very first attempt. If a student failed a minor subject in their second year, but cleared it a month later in the supplementary exams and eventually went on to secure a 9.9 CGPA, they are completely disqualified from the medal race. Medals are reserved strictly for flawless, uninterrupted academic trajectories.

The medals are awarded based on the final Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) calculated at the end of the eighth semester. However, in highly competitive branches like Computer Science, it is common for multiple students to tie with the exact same CGPA (e.g., three students holding a 9.85). In the event of a mathematical tie, the university executes a rigid tie-breaker protocol:

1. **First Tie-Breaker:** The student with the higher absolute marks in the eighth-semester Major Final Year Project (out of 200) wins the medal.
2. **Second Tie-Breaker:** If the project marks are also identical, the administration evaluates the core professional elective (PEC) grades. The student who took the highest number of advanced mathematical or algorithmic electives, as classified by the Dean of Academics, is awarded the medal.
3. **Third Tie-Breaker:** In the exceedingly rare case that all metrics match perfectly, the university will invoke a co-award, minting an additional Gold Medal to honor both students equally.

5. Degree Withholding and Disciplinary Exclusions

The university retains the absolute legal right to withhold a student's Original Degree, even if they have passed all examinations and paid all tuition fees, if a severe post-academic violation is discovered.

If, between the completion of the final exams in May and the convocation in November, a student is convicted of a criminal felony, indicted for severe corporate fraud at their new workplace, or found to have engaged in massive plagiarism that went undetected during the thesis submission, the university will halt the degree conferral. The case is forwarded to the University Senate. If the Senate determines that the student's actions have brought severe disrepute to the institution, they will vote to permanently cancel the graduation, revoking the B.Tech degree completely.

Furthermore, any student who has an active, unresolved disciplinary case pending with the Anti-Ragging Committee or the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) will have their degree placed on administrative hold. They are barred from attending the convocation until the committee delivers a formal acquittal.

6. The In-Absentia Dispatch Protocol

The university understands that many graduates may have relocated to foreign countries for higher education or begun demanding corporate jobs that prevent them from traveling back to Hyderabad for the November convocation. These students must apply to receive their Original Degree "In-Absentia."

During the online convocation registration, the student must select the "In-Absentia Postal Delivery" option.

- **Domestic Shipping:** For delivery within India, the student must pay an additional highly-secure courier tracking fee of ₹500.
- **International Shipping:** For delivery to a foreign address (e.g., a university campus in the United States or the UK), the student must pay a flat international logistics fee of ₹4,500.

The Dispatch Timeline: Degrees requested in-absentia are not shipped immediately after the convocation ceremony. The examination branch requires time to audit the remaining physical degrees. All in-absentia degrees are handed over to the institutional courier partner exactly forty-five calendar days *after* the physical convocation date. The university takes no responsibility for degrees lost in international transit due to incorrect addresses provided by the student on the portal. If a degree is lost in the mail, the student must file a formal police FIR for a missing document, publish a notice in a national newspaper, and pay a ₹5,000 reprint fee to receive a "Duplicate Original Degree."